



**Precalculus Algebra
MATH 90
Section: S61 CRN: 73966**

Welcome!

Hello, and welcome to Math 90. My name is Jack, and I'm excited to get to know you and work with you over the next few months.

This syllabus outlines everything you need to know to succeed in this course. Give it a thorough read and, as always, reach out to me in person, by email, or on Canvas with any questions or concerns.

I'm looking forward to a fun and challenging semester. I hope you are too!

Course overview and philosophy

This course is designed with your active participation in mind. Lectures will comprise less than half of our class time. For most of class time, you will work alone and in groups to understand the material through activities and discussion. This may feel uncomfortable, especially if you are used to a more passive math class where the teacher is at the board, and the students are taking notes. But the discomfort is good; learn to befriend it. Learning is uncomfortable because you bump into your own limitations and then push them a little further than they were yesterday. Through this process, you develop a sense of agency over the material. Your understanding is your own, because you arrived at it yourself. This kind of understanding is its own reward, and a good grade is the natural outcome.

Course details

We use Active Prelude, an online textbook designed to support an active learning class like the one just described (see **Course Materials** section below). We cover one section of the text each class period (see **Course Calendar** section below). Your grade is based on the **Preview Activity**, **Activities**, and **Exercises** found in each section, as well as **Chapter Assessments** and a **Final Exam**. Here is a summary of each grading category (see the **Grading Policies and Evaluation Methods** section below for information on how they contribute to your course grade).

Preview Activities

Preview Activities get you thinking about each topic before we cover it in class. They are completed online and are due by 10:00 am on the day that we cover that topic. For example, we cover *1.1 Changing in Tandem* on Monday, August 24. The 1.1 Preview Activity is due at 10:00 am that morning.

Activities

Activities help you think actively, collaborate, and solve problems during class as part of the learning process. Complete them in your course workbook. I check for completion at the end of the Support class each day.

Exercises

Exercises expand and deepen the understanding you develop during class. They are completed online and are due at 11:55 pm the day after we cover that topic. For example, we cover *1.1 Changing in Tandem* on Monday, August 24. The 1.1 Exercises are due at 11:55 pm on Tuesday, August 25.

Chapter Assessments

Chapter Assessments test your individual understanding of the material in

each chapter. They are given during class, and you have the entire class period to complete them. Questions on the Chapter Assessments closely resemble Activities and Exercises from the sections in that chapter.

Final Exam

The Final Exam tests your understanding of a range of topics covered throughout the course. It takes place on December 18 from 10:30 am to 12:30 pm. Questions on the Final Exam closely resemble questions on the Chapter Assessments.

Grading Policies and Evaluation Methods

Your course grade is based on the following weighted categories:

Preview Activities - 15%

Each section has one preview activity.

Activities - 15%

Each section typically has 2 to 4 activities. Each section is weighted the same and is graded on completion, not accuracy. You can miss 2 sections of activities without affecting your grade.

Exercises - 20%

Each section has between 1 and 8 exercises, and each section is weighted the same.

Chapter Assessments - 30%

There are 4 chapter assessments, covering chapters 1, 2, 3, and 5. Each is weighted the same.

Final Exam - 20%

A cumulative final exam will be given at the end of the semester.

Letter grades for the course will be assigned based on the following rubric:

A	93-100%
A-	90-92%
B+	87-89%
B	83-86%
B-	80-82%
C+	77-79%
C	73-76%
C-	70-72%
D	60-69%
F	<60%

The support class, Math 90S is Pass/Fail. If you pass Math 90, you pass Math 90S. If you fail Math 90, you fail Math 90S. We will use the time during the support class to continue our lectures and activities from that day's regular class, and get a jump on the exercises for that day's section of the text.

Course Calendar

Here is a tentative schedule for the entire semester. Note that there are two review/buffer days at the end of the term. We may use these during the semester if we fall behind, or save them for review days before the final if possible. Any changes to the following schedule will be made in this document as they arise, so the syllabus posted on Canvas will always be up to date.

Day	Date	Section
W	8/19	Introductions
M	8/24	1.1
W	8/26	1.2
M	8/31	1.3
W	9/2	1.4
M	9/7	No class
W	9/9	1.5
M	9/14	1.6
W	9/16	1.7
M	9/21	1.8
W	9/23	1.9
M	9/28	Ch 1 Assessment
W	9/30	2.1
M	10/5	2.2
W	10/7	2.3
M	10/12	No class
W	10/14	2.4
M	10/19	Ch 2 Assessment
W	10/21	3.1
M	10/26	3.2
W	10/28	3.3
M	11/2	3.4
W	11/4	3.5
M	11/9	3.6
W	11/11	No class
M	11/16	Ch 3 Assessment
W	11/18	5.1
M	11/23	5.2
W	11/25	5.3
M	11/30	5.4
W	12/2	5.5
M	12/7	Ch 5 Assessment
W	12/9	Review/buffer day
M	12/14	Review/buffer day
F	12/18	Final exam

Equity Statement

The following was adapted by Alisa Messer, CCSF English Department. I include it here in solidarity with its message.

☛ You belong here! Please keep me informed if you find yourself struggling or a situation arises that hinders your success in our class. I hope you will join me in committing to fostering a learning and working environment based on open communication and mutual respect and to building as safe and healthy a community for learning as we can. As an educator, I fully support the rights of undocumented students to an education and to live free from the fear of deportation. I am committed to CCSF as a sanctuary campus and will not assist any attempts to ascertain the immigration status of members of our classroom community. If you have any concerns, please feel free to discuss them with me, and I will respect your wishes concerning confidentiality. Likewise, if you face challenges with sufficient food or housing, or if there are other threats to your security and well-being, this is likely to affect your learning. I want you to be successful and to help you find resources: please talk to me and I will try to help you find the support you need.

Instructor Information

Name: Jack Love
Email: jlove@ccsf.edu

Course Information

Course Description/Overview

Real functions and their graphs; one-to-one and inverse functions; polynomial, rational, exponential and logarithmic functions; complex numbers and zeros of polynomials; linear systems and matrices; geometric transformations and conic sections; topics in discrete mathematics.

Transferability
UC/CSU

Requisites/Advisories
PREREQ: Intermediate algebra or higher
Grading Options
Letter

Student Learning Outcomes

1. Define, graph, interpret, and apply functions, their transformations, and their respective inverse functions.
2. Construct functions to model and analyze real-world situations.
3. Describe and graph polynomial, rational, exponential and logarithmic functions and apply their properties to solve equations and applications.
4. Identify, compare, and contrast the equations, graphs, and properties of conic sections.

Class Meeting Information

Start and End Dates

August 19, 2026 - December 22, 2026

Important Dates:

Last day to add: September 4, 2026

Last day for refund: September 1, 2026

Last day to drop without W: September 4, 2026

Last day to drop with W: November 13, 2026

Last day to elect pass/no pass: NA

Class Meeting Information		
Days	Times	Location
MW	10:10 am - 12:25 pm	Student Health Center 206

Course Materials

ACTIVE PRELUDE TO
CALCULUS
2019 Edition



Matthew Boelkins

Title: Active Prelude to Calculus
ISBN: 9781085940856
Authors: Matthew Boelkins
Publisher: Independently Published
Publication Date: 2019-07-28

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

Students who need disability-related accommodations should register with Disability Services & Programs for Students (DSPS). DSPS can be reached in person on the first floor of the Student Success Building, by phone at (415) 452-5481, or by email at dspacom@ccsf.edu. Visit the [DSPS website](#) for office hours and information about services at the John Adams and Mission Centers.

If you have approved accommodations, please provide your current DSPS accommodation letter (CATAV) to your instructor as soon as possible. Accommodation letters must be renewed each semester. If you have disability- or medical-related needs, including emergency evacuation accommodations, please contact a DSPS counselor.

DSPS also offers accessible computer labs located in Batmale 231 and John Adams 104 and are open to all students.

Non-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy

CCSF adheres to all applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations that uphold the principle of equal opportunity and prohibit discrimination and harassment on the basis of race, color, ancestry, national origin, ethnic group identification, religion, age, sex, gender,

gender identity, gender expression, marital status, domestic partner status, sexual orientation, disability or medical conditions, AIDS/HIV status, military or veteran status, pregnancy or pregnancy-related conditions, or on the basis of these perceived characteristics, or based on association with a person or group with one or more of these actual or perceived characteristics.

These laws and regulations include but are not limited to the California Education Code, the California Code of Regulation Title 5, the Equal Employment Opportunity Act, the Americans with Disabilities Act, the Rehabilitation Act (1973) §504, and Title IX, which prohibits sex-based discrimination including sexual harassment, sexual assault, domestic/dating violence, and stalking. For more information about students' rights to access the College's programs and activities, or if you believe you have been subjected to discrimination or harassment, please visit the Office of Civil Rights Compliance (OCRC) webpage to submit an online report or contact [CCSF's Title IX Coordinator, Alex Brouwer](mailto:TitleIX@ccsf.edu) at TitleIX@ccsf.edu. If you are a pregnant student, please contact the Title IX Coordinator to learn more about your rights including how to request reasonable accommodations.

Math Department Policy on AI Usage

AI Usage by Students

Instructors may define AI use in their courses, and course policies take precedence. In the absence of a course policy, the following applies. Students are not required to use AI. If a student does use it, it may be used only to support learning. Using AI to produce work that a student then submits as their own thinking and effort is not permitted, and disclosing that use does not make it permitted. Students must disclose AI use when it meaningfully contributes to their work, and students are responsible for the accuracy of everything they submit.

No paid tools are required unless explicitly specified in your published course materials. Concerns are addressed first through discussion and

review of the student's process. Confirmed violations of this policy or of the instructor's course policy are a violation of the Student Code of Conduct.

Standards of Conduct

Students who register in CCSF classes must abide by the [CCSF Student Code of Conduct](#). Violation of the code is the basis for referral to the Office of Student Conduct & Discipline and may result in dismissal from class or the College. See the [Office of Student Affairs](#).

Collaborating on or copying of tests or homework in whole or in part will be considered an act of academic dishonesty. See these resources on plagiarism:

[Encourage Academic Integrity and Prevent Plagiarism](#)

[Citing Information Sources](#)

Academic Tutoring

As a City College student, you can access many free services to help you succeed in your classes and navigate college. Please come to the STAR (student tutoring and resource) Center for free Peer and Professional tutoring and mentoring, individual or group study spaces, workshops that center your learning needs, an open-access computer lab with printing, and a welcoming community. Our centers and labs are free and available online and in person. Please join us: we care about your success!

Visit the [Tutoring Centers](#).

Library

[City College of San Francisco's Library](#) offers many services to help you with your classes.

Take online library workshops, learn how to get started on a research project, borrow textbooks and other instructional materials, and much more.

[Borrow Technology from the Library](#) - Chromebooks, laptops, and hotspots can be borrowed from all CCSF Libraries.

Visit City College libraries in person at Rosenberg (at Ocean Campus), the Chinatown/North Beach Center, the Downtown Center, the Evans Center, the John Adams Center, and the Mission Center.

A librarian is on-site and available to help during [open hours](#).

Student Services

Ram Resources

[Ram Resources](#) is a searchable resource hub to help you navigate CCSF programs, services, and resources.

Financial Aid

Unlock Your Financial Aid Potential: FAFSA/CADAA Adventure Awaits! Learn more about [FAFSA](#) and [CADAA](#). We encourage you to apply to maximize all Financial Aid resources. Visit the Financial Aid Office located in SSC Building 112. Email: finaid@ccsf.edu or [Financial Aid Virtual Counter](#).

Counseling

[Counselors](#) are here to help you find your way through City College. Create an [Educational Plan](#) with a Counselor and make progress towards your academic goals.

Admissions and Records

The [Office of Admissions and Records/Registration](#) can help with applying to CCSF, registering for classes, accessing academic records, and completing your degree. Visit SSC 1124 for assistance.